

Those icons on your camera dial!



Wouldn't it be awkward if you had to ask your seven year old how to switch from shutter mode to aperture mode on your camera? Do you know which is the best setting to have while taking a landscape picture? If you find yourself clueless when choosing the correct settings on your camera then this guide will explain those little icons on your camera dial and save you from the embarrassment



Auto mode – This is the favorite setting for a photography noob. The icon is generally green. If

you select this mode the camera takes care of all the adjustments like exposure and shutter speed. All you have to do is to press the shutter button and get an almost perfect image.



Manual mode – The higher souls of photography choose this mode to capture their

subject. You can control everything from aperture size to shutter speed. At the same time since you are working without a safety net, the camera would not take care of under or over exposure.



Aperture mode – Select this mode to blur the background of your subject or to keep the image in sharp focus. When you select this mode you control the aperture priority while the shutter priority is automatically selected.



Shutter mode – Choose this mode to capture action photography.

Remember if you keep the shutter speed high you can freeze the subject while on the other hand keep the shutter speed low to capture motion in the picture



Program mode – This is Auto

mode on steroids. The program mode selects the best shutter and aperture settings while at the same time giving you more control to select the white balance and exposure. You can even tweak shutter speed up or down a bit.



Movie mode – Use this mode to record movies in various video-formats. The movie gets stored

to the same data card or camera memory where your images are.



Macro mode – Choose the flower icon to take images of nearby objects, within a few inches of distance. You can take life size images of flowers or insects or other small objects. However you have to compromise on focus range as it would be very narrow.



Landscape mode – Its advis-

able to select the landscape mode when clicking pictures in the outdoors. This mode automatically selects the best aperture and shutter settings giving you the required depth of field to capture your outdoor shot.



Sand and snow mode – Brightly coloured background or other glaring objects often trick

the camera into under exposing a shot. Choosing this mode the shot is over-exposed giving you details that would otherwise be lost.



Action mode – Also called the sports mode, this is best for taking shots of sports activity. When

you choose the sports mode the camera selects the shutter speed at the highest level giving you clear shot of the object.



Night mode – The crescent moon symbol means that the camera would automatically

select the best settings to enable you to click images in low light or at night time. This setting enables the use of Flash and uses fast shutter speed to capture people in the foreground. This allows lights from cars, buildings and other elements to show in the background.

Demystifying video game genres

You might have often heard these terms being used when people discuss new game releases or game consoles. Here's what they mean

Action-Adventure – Perhaps the broadest of video game genres. Games falling into this category include adventure gameplay along with elements from the action genre. First game released under this genre was in 1979 called Adventure for the Atari 2600.

First Person Shooters (FPS)



The gameplay of an FPS game revolves around a gun or other projectile weapon and is seen by the eyes of the

protagonist. The game is in first person perspective. Some of the famous games in this genre are Halo, Call of Duty, Quake and Crysis.

MMORPG – Expanding as Massively multiplayer online role-playing game, in this genre a large number of players play and interact with each other in a virtual world. The in game universe keeps on developing and expanding and is usually hosted by the game publisher. The biggest MMORPG is World of Warcraft with 12 million players worldwide.



RTS – In Real time strategy the players deploy and command armies, warships and other war units

to designated spots on a map. Additional items such as maps, army units can be purchased in the game by spending special coins or resources ensuring victory. A famous example is Age of Empires.



Life Simulation

– This genre has players behaving the way they do in real life controlling artificial avatars

of themselves in a virtual universe. One of the most popular game in this genre is The Sims which released in 2000.